

Shakeups to Begin At Country Campus

Special to The Waco News-Tribune

COUNTRY CAMPUS, March 26—The first players trimmed from the Pittsburgh roster in Florida have started arriving at Country Campus, always the first move in a chain reaction which eventually will determine the personnel of Waco's baseball team for 1956.

Jackie Brown, the fire-balling righthander who hurled with success last season for the Waco team, came in Monday from Florida, and outfielder John Powers was due momentarily. Both received try-outs with Bobby Bragan's major leaguers, then were sent back for further seasoning.

They will be re-assigned here, probably to the New Orleans team of the Southern Association. More players will follow them from Florida, and from the Hollywood club of the Pacific Coast League, later this week.

The arrival of those talented and experienced players will prompt Andy Cohen to trim his present New Orleans roster, and that in turn will start some roster trummings by Class A Williamsport and Lincoln, and then the players will be on hand to set up Waco's roster.

Branch Rickey Jr., head of Pittsburgh's farm clubs, is due in camp later this week to start setting up the New Orleans team, which means Waco's time should arrive about April 5 or 6.

Meanwhile the intra-squad games continued on the four practice diamonds without pause. Some 160 players are now in camp, seeking positions on the eight Pittsburgh farm clubs in training here.

Waco manager Monty Basgall Monday admitted he could see several players he would like to have on his 1956 Pirate team, but he feared higher clubs would grab them off.

"This (Rex) Babcock looks like a fine player but I think Williamsport has an eye on him," he said. He also liked the work of Alvin Jackson, the Moore High youngster who pitched for Waco last year and now seeks a promotion.

Basgall has limited his actual playing thus far to pinch-hitting duties.

"I'm going to start playing all the time in a couple of days, though," he said. "I'm planning to do a lot of playing this year for Waco."

Rule Change To Slow Big Man--Hayes

DALLAS, March 26 (AP)—Southern Methodist Coach E. O. (Doc) Hayes thinks only a single basketball rules change will materially affect the game next season—it will remove one threat of big men like Bill Russell of San Francisco.

The National Basketball Committee adopted six rules changes at Chicago yesterday. One of them said "no offensive player may reach above the cylinder to guide an attempted shot into the basket."

Hayes said that Russell used his hands "like sideboard to guide the ball into the basket."

"Russell is graduating but Wilt (The Stilt) Chamberlain, the Kansas freshman, will be playing varsity basketball next season," Hayes observed. "This rule change will prevent his doing the same as Russell did with so much effect."

Hayes, whose team was Southwest Conference and Western NCAA Regional champion and lost to San Francisco in the NCAA semifinals, said he figured the thinking of the rules committee in adopting this rule change was to not let a team dominate the game as did San Francisco.

The SMU coach wasn't clear on the intent of some of the rules changes and said he would have to study them further before commenting on them but that the one